

Network Device	Primary Function	How It Works	Real-World Use Case (Daily Apps/Services)
Router	Connects your home network to the Internet and routes data between networks.	Assigns IP addresses (DHCP), forwards packets, and often provides Wi-Fi.	Watching YouTube , browsing websites, using WhatsApp , or attending Google Meet/Zoom calls through your home Wi-Fi.
Switch	Connects multiple wired devices within the same Local Area Network (LAN).	Sends data only to the intended device using MAC addresses, making communication faster and more efficient.	Connecting a gaming PC , NAS , and desktop computer for fast LAN file transfers or LAN gaming with minimal latency.
Hub	Connects multiple devices on a LAN (legacy device).	Broadcasts incoming data to all connected devices, regardless of the destination.	Rarely used today, but can be found in network training labs to demonstrate packet broadcasting and network traffic analysis.
Access Point (AP)	Provides wireless (Wi-Fi) connectivity to devices on a wired network.	Extends or creates a Wi-Fi network so wireless devices can connect to the LAN.	Connecting a smartphone , tablet , smart TV , or laptop to stream YouTube , Netflix , or browse the web over Wi-Fi.